

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 32

Jonah

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 32*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Genesis

Jonah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 One day long ago, GOD's Word came to Jonah, Amittai's son:
- 1 The word of the LORD came to Jonah son of Amittai:
- 2 "Up on your feet and on your way to the big city of Nineveh! Preach to them. They're in a bad way and I can't ignore it any longer."
- 2 Go to the great city of Nineveh and preach against it, because its wickedness has come up before me.
- 3 But Jonah got up and went the other direction to Tarshish, running away from GOD. He went down to the port of Joppa and found a ship headed for Tarshish. He paid the fare and went on board, joining those going to Tarshish--as far away from GOD as he could get.
- 3 But Jonah ran away from the LORD and headed for Tarshish. He went down to Joppa, where he found a ship bound for that port. After paying the fare, he went aboard and sailed for Tarshish to flee from the LORD.
- 4 But GOD sent a huge storm at sea, the waves towering. The ship was about to break into pieces.
- 4 Then the LORD sent a great wind on the sea, and such a violent storm arose that the ship threatened to break up.
- 5 The sailors were terrified. They called out in desperation to their gods. They threw everything they were carrying overboard to lighten the ship. Meanwhile, Jonah had gone down into the hold of the ship to take a nap. He was sound asleep.
- 5 All the sailors were afraid and each cried out to his own god. And they threw the cargo into the sea to lighten the ship. But Jonah had gone below deck, where he lay down and fell into a deep sleep.
- 6 The captain came to him and said, "What's this? Sleeping! Get up! Pray to your god! Maybe your god will see we're in trouble and rescue us."

- 6 The captain went to him and said, "How can you sleep? Get up and call on your god! Maybe he will take notice of us, and we will not perish."
- 7 Then the sailors said to one another, "Let's get to the bottom of this. Let's draw straws to identify the culprit on this ship who's responsible for this disaster." So they drew straws. Jonah got the short straw.
- 7 Then the sailors said to each other, "Come, let us cast lots to find out who is responsible for this calamity." They cast lots and the lot fell on Jonah.
- 8 Then they grilled him: "Confess. Why this disaster? What is your work? Where do you come from? What country? What family?"
- 8 So they asked him, "Tell us, who is responsible for making all this trouble for us? What do you do? Where do you come from? What is your country? From what people are you?"
- 9 He told them, "I'm a Hebrew. I worship GOD, the God of heaven who made sea and land."
- 9 He answered, "I am a Hebrew and I worship the LORD, the God of heaven, who made the sea and the land."
- 10 At that, the men were frightened, really frightened, and said, "What on earth have you done!" As Jonah talked, the sailors realized that he was running away from GOD.
- 10 This terrified them and they asked, "What have you done?" (They knew he was running away from the LORD, because he had already told them so.)
- 11 They said to him, "What are we going to do with you--to get rid of this storm?" By this time the sea was wild, totally out of control.
- 11 The sea was getting rougher and rougher. So they asked him, "What should we do to you to make the sea calm down for us?"
- 12 Jonah said, "Throw me overboard, into the sea. Then the storm will stop. It's all my fault. I'm the cause of the storm. Get rid of me and you'll get rid of the storm."
- 12 Pick me up and throw me into the sea, he replied, "and it will become calm. I know that it is my fault that this great storm has come upon you."
- 13 But no. The men tried rowing back to shore. They made no headway. The storm only got worse and worse, wild and raging.
- 13 Instead, the men did their best to row back to land. But they could not, for the sea grew even wilder than before.

- 14 Then they prayed to GOD, "O GOD! Don't let us drown because of this man's life, and don't blame us for his death. You are GOD. Do what you think is best."
- 14 Then they cried to the LORD, "O LORD, please do not let us die for taking this man's life. Do not hold us accountable for killing an innocent man, for you, O LORD, have done as you pleased."
- 15 They took Jonah and threw him overboard. Immediately the sea was quieted down.
- 15 Then they took Jonah and threw him overboard, and the raging sea grew calm.
- 16 The sailors were impressed, no longer terrified by the sea, but in awe of GOD. They worshiped GOD, offered a sacrifice, and made vows.
- 16 At this the men greatly feared the LORD, and they offered a sacrifice to the LORD and made vows to him.
- 17 Then GOD assigned a huge fish to swallow Jonah. Jonah was in the fish's belly three days and nights.
- 17 But the LORD provided a great fish to swallow Jonah, and Jonah was inside the fish three days and three nights.

Jonah 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Jonah prayed to his God from the belly of the fish.
- 1 From inside the fish Jonah prayed to the LORD his God.
- 2 He prayed: "In trouble, deep trouble, I prayed to GOD. He answered me. From the belly of the grave I cried, 'Help!' You heard my cry.
- 2 He said: "In my distress I called to the LORD, and he answered me. From the depths of the grave I called for help, and you listened to my cry.
- 3 You threw me into ocean's depths, into a watery grave, With ocean waves, ocean breakers crashing over me.
- 3 You hurled me into the deep, into the very heart of the seas, and the currents swirled about me; all your waves and breakers swept over me.
- 4 I said, 'I've been thrown away, thrown out, out of your sight. I'll never again lay eyes on your Holy Temple.'

- 4 I said, 'I have been banished from your sight; yet I will look again toward your holy temple.'
- 5 Ocean gripped me by the throat. The ancient Abyss grabbed me and held tight. My head was all tangled in seaweed
- 5 The engulfing waters threatened me, the deep surrounded me; seaweed was wrapped around my head.
- 6 at the bottom of the sea where the mountains take root. I was as far down as a body can go, and the gates were slamming shut behind me forever-- Yet you pulled me up from that grave alive, O GOD, my God!
- 6 To the roots of the mountains I sank down; the earth beneath barred me in forever. But you brought my life up from the pit, O LORD my God.
- 7 When my life was slipping away, I remembered GOD, And my prayer got through to you, made it all the way to your Holy Temple.
- 7 When my life was ebbing away, I remembered you, LORD, and my prayer rose to you, to your holy temple.
- 8 Those who worship hollow gods, god-frauds, walk away from their only true love.
- 8 Those who cling to worthless idols forfeit the grace that could be theirs.
- 9 But I'm worshipping you, GOD, calling out in thanksgiving! And I'll do what I promised I'd do! Salvation belongs to GOD!"
- 9 But I, with a song of thanksgiving, will sacrifice to you. What I have vowed I will make good. Salvation comes from the LORD."
- 10 Then GOD spoke to the fish, and it vomited up Jonah on the seashore.
- 10 And the LORD commanded the fish, and it vomited Jonah onto dry land.

Jonah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Next, GOD spoke to Jonah a second time:
- 1 Then the word of the LORD came to Jonah a second time:
- 2 "Up on your feet and on your way to the big city of Nineveh! Preach to them. They're in a bad way and I can't ignore it any longer."
- 2 Go to the great city of Nineveh and proclaim to it the message I give you.

- 3 This time Jonah started off straight for Nineveh, obeying GOD's orders to the letter. Nineveh was a big city, very big--it took three days to walk across it.
- 3 Jonah obeyed the word of the LORD and went to Nineveh. Now Nineveh was a very important city--a visit required three days.
- 4 Jonah entered the city, went one day's walk and preached, "In forty days Nineveh will be smashed."
- 4 On the first day, Jonah started into the city. He proclaimed: "Forty more days and Nineveh will be overturned."
- 5 The people of Nineveh listened, and trusted God. They proclaimed a citywide fast and dressed in burlap to show their repentance. Everyone did it--rich and poor, famous and obscure, leaders and followers.
- 5 The Ninevites believed God. They declared a fast, and all of them, from the greatest to the least, put on sackcloth.
- 6 When the message reached the king of Nineveh, he got up off his throne, threw down his royal robes, dressed in burlap, and sat down in the dirt.
- 6 When the news reached the king of Nineveh, he rose from his throne, took off his royal robes, covered himself with sackcloth and sat down in the dust.
- 7 Then he issued a public proclamation throughout Nineveh, authorized by him and his leaders: "Not one drop of water, not one bite of food for man, woman, or animal, including your herds and flocks!"
- 7 Then he issued a proclamation in Nineveh: "By the decree of the king and his nobles: Do not let any man or beast, herd or flock, taste anything; do not let them eat or drink.
- 8 Dress them all, both people and animals, in burlap, and send up a cry for help to God. Everyone must turn around, turn back from an evil life and the violent ways that stain their hands.
- 8 But let man and beast be covered with sackcloth. Let everyone call urgently on God. Let them give up their evil ways and their violence.
- 9 Who knows? Maybe God will turn around and change his mind about us, quit being angry with us and let us live!"
- 9 Who knows? God may yet relent and with compassion turn from his fierce anger so that we will not perish."
- 10 God saw what they had done, that they had turned away from their evil lives. He did change his mind about them. What he said he would do to

them he didn't do.

- 10 When God saw what they did and how they turned from their evil ways, he had compassion and did not bring upon them the destruction he had threatened.

Jonah 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jonah was furious. He lost his temper.
- 1 But Jonah was greatly displeased and became angry.
- 2 He yelled at GOD, "GOD! I knew it--when I was back home, I knew this was going to happen! That's why I ran off to Tarshish! I knew you were sheer grace and mercy, not easily angered, rich in love, and ready at the drop of a hat to turn your plans of punishment into a program of forgiveness!
- 2 He prayed to the LORD, "O LORD, is this not what I said when I was still at home? That is why I was so quick to flee to Tarshish. I knew that you are a gracious and compassionate God, slow to anger and abounding in love, a God who relents from sending calamity.
- 3 "So, GOD, if you won't kill them, kill me! I'm better off dead!"
- 3 Now, O LORD, take away my life, for it is better for me to die than to live."
- 4 GOD said, "What do you have to be angry about?"
- 4 But the LORD replied, "Have you any right to be angry?"
- 5 But Jonah just left. He went out of the city to the east and sat down in a sulk. He put together a makeshift shelter of leafy branches and sat there in the shade to see what would happen to the city.
- 5 Jonah went out and sat down at a place east of the city. There he made himself a shelter, sat in its shade and waited to see what would happen to the city.
- 6 GOD arranged for a broad-leafed tree to spring up. It grew over Jonah to cool him off and get him out of his angry sulk. Jonah was pleased and enjoyed the shade. Life was looking up.
- 6 Then the LORD God provided a vine and made it grow up over Jonah to give shade for his head to ease his discomfort, and Jonah was very happy

about the vine.

- 7 But then God sent a worm. By dawn of the next day, the worm had bored into the shade tree and it withered away.
- 7 But at dawn the next day God provided a worm, which chewed the vine so that it withered.
- 8 The sun came up and God sent a hot, blistering wind from the east. The sun beat down on Jonah's head and he started to faint. He prayed to die: "I'm better off dead!"
- 8 When the sun rose, God provided a scorching east wind, and the sun blazed on Jonah's head so that he grew faint. He wanted to die, and said, "It would be better for me to die than to live."
- 9 Then God said to Jonah, "What right do you have to get angry about this shade tree?" Jonah said, "Plenty of right. It's made me angry enough to die!"
- 9 But God said to Jonah, "Do you have a right to be angry about the vine?" "I do," he said. "I am angry enough to die."
- 10 GOD said, "What's this? How is it that you can change your feelings from pleasure to anger overnight about a mere shade tree that you did nothing to get? You neither planted nor watered it. It grew up one night and died the next night.
- 10 But the LORD said, "You have been concerned about this vine, though you did not tend it or make it grow. It sprang up overnight and died overnight.
- 11 So, why can't I likewise change what I feel about Nineveh from anger to pleasure, this big city of more than a hundred and twenty thousand childlike people who don't yet know right from wrong, to say nothing of all the innocent animals?"
- 11 But Nineveh has more than a hundred and twenty thousand people who cannot tell their right hand from their left, and many cattle as well. Should I not be concerned about that great city?"